

How can we coordinate globally such a varied concept?

Quantitative Sustainability

David Lusseau

Rio Declaration 1992

- “Human beings are at the centre of concerns for sustainable development...”
- “...equitably meet developmental and environmental needs of present and future generations.”
- “... environmental protection shall constitute an integral part of the development process....”

DTU Reaching consensus



What is at the origin of nowadays SDGs?

- The modern *sustainability* concept emerged from interactions between economic development & environmentalism
- Consensus I: 1972 Stockholm Declaration
 - Our activities (particularly industrialization) are having an impact on the global environment
 - We need to assess the impact of our activities and manage them

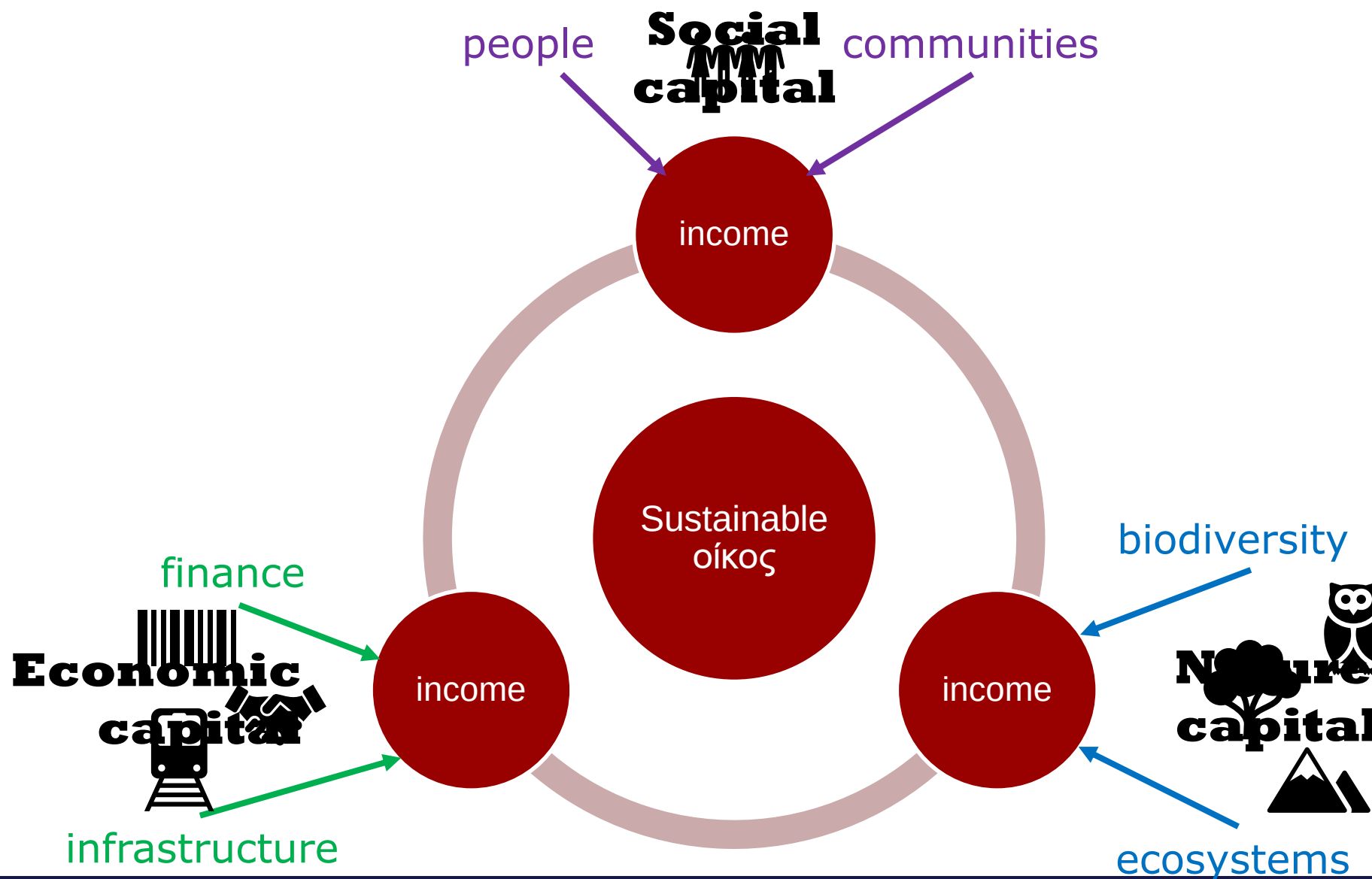
Universal Declaration of Human Rights (1948)

- **Article 1** – All human beings are born free and equal in dignity and rights.
- **Article 2** – Everyone is entitled to all the rights and freedoms set forth in this Declaration, without distinction of any kind.
- **Article 25** - Everyone has the right to a standard of living adequate for the health and well-being of himself and of his family.

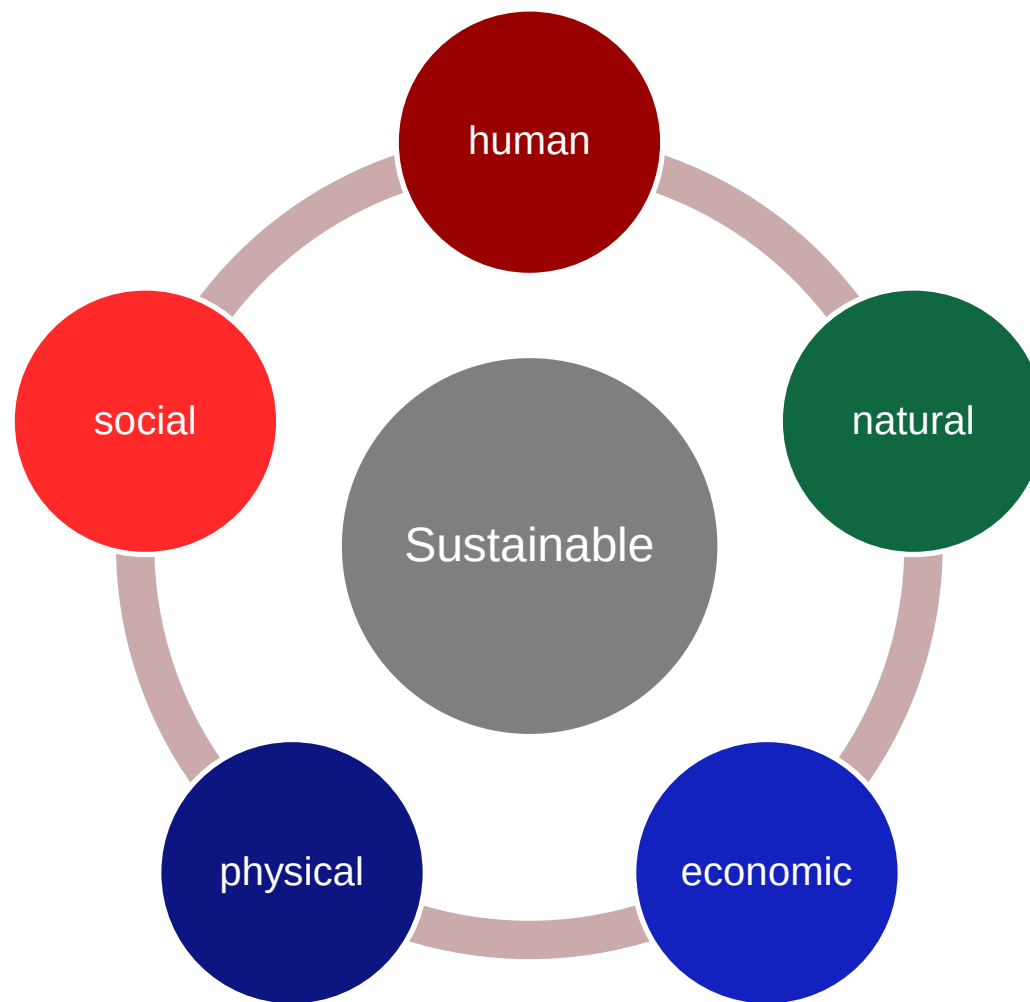
What is at the origin of nowadays SDGs?

- The modern *sustainability* concept emerged from interactions between economic development & environmentalism
- Consensus II: 1992 Rio Declaration
 - Reconcile Stockholm declaration with economic development & UDHR
 - needed for global security
 - needed to adhere to Universal Human Rights

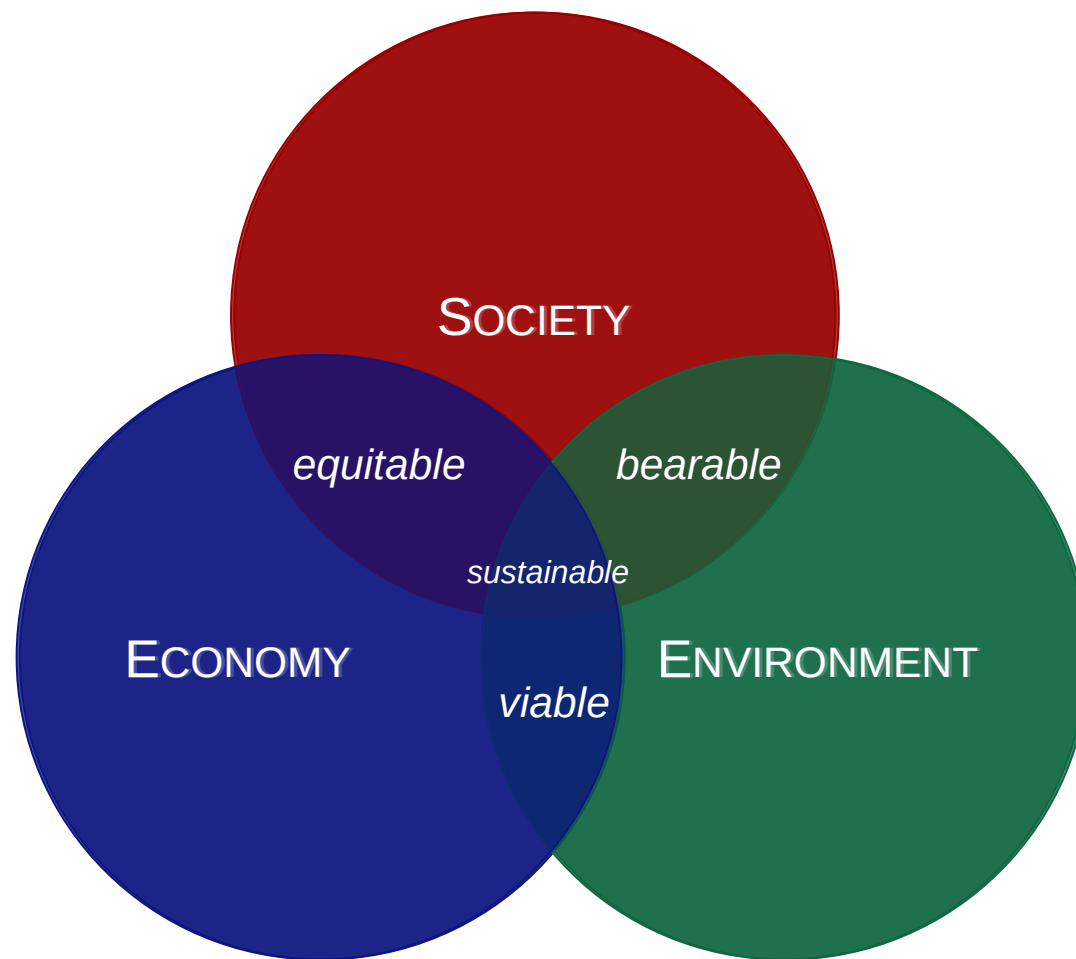
Implementing Rio 1992: Socioecological perspective



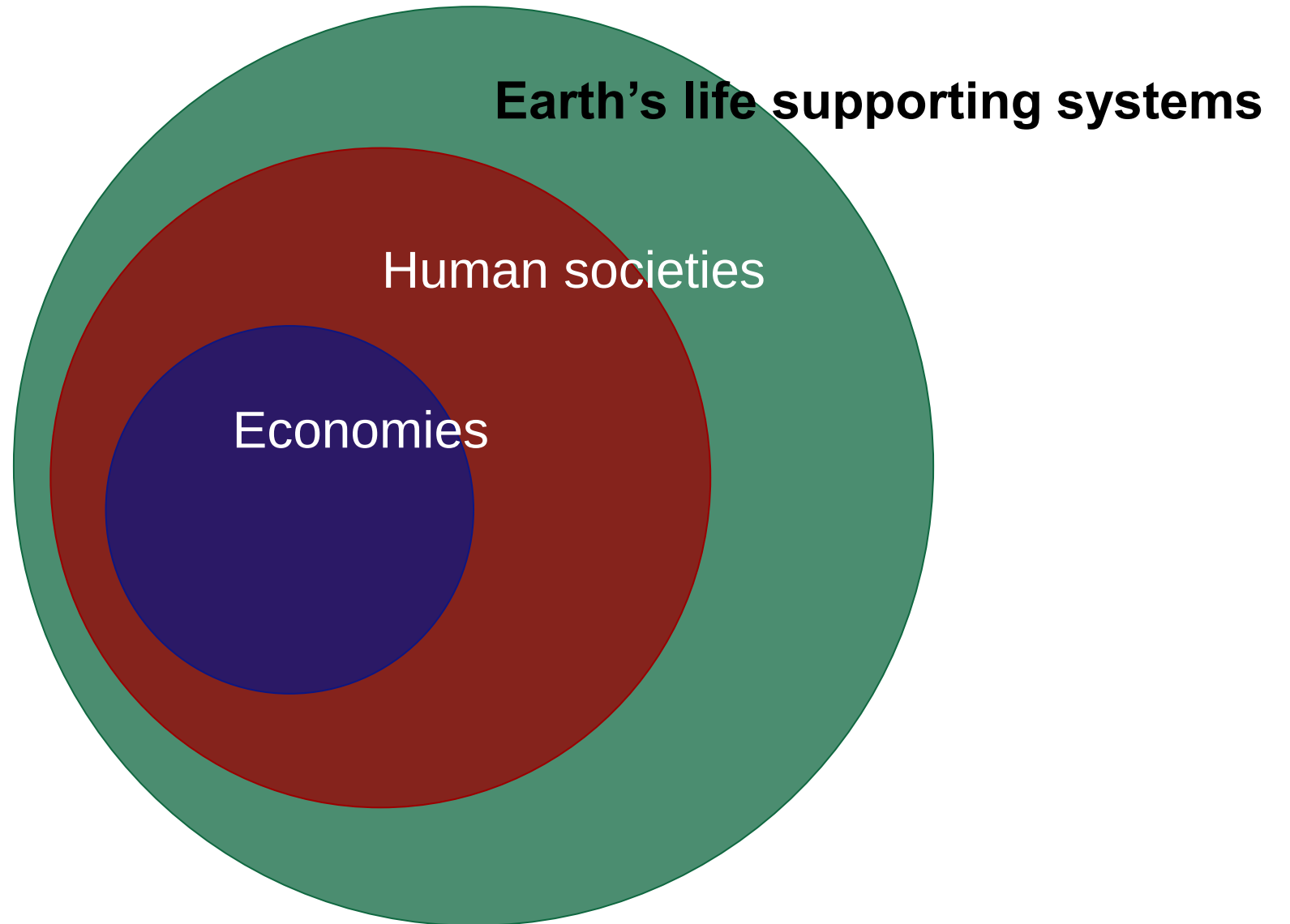
Alternative formulation



Alternative formulation



Alternative formulation



Operational definition

- We have a consensus definition
- We have a framework in which human-nature relations can be operationalized across worldviews to meet this definition
- Consensus-building takes a long time